

EC unveils age verification app to enforce Digital Services Act

The European Commission (EC) has launched an open source age verification app, positioning it as public digital infrastructure that is transparent, auditable, and adaptable across member states and private ecosystems. The model is designed to enable trust through verifiability, ensure interoperability with EU systems, and allow customisation without weakening privacy protections.

The rollout aligns with a broader EU child-safety and digital governance strategy under the Digital Services Act, alongside an action plan targeting cyberbullying, harmful content, and addictive platform design. The system will integrate with the EU Digital Identity (EUDI) Wallet, reinforcing a unified regulatory and technical framework while shifting compliance responsibility firmly onto platforms.

Ursula von der Leyen, president of the European Commission, said the solution is “technically ready” and warned of “zero tolerance” for non-compliance, adding that it meets “the highest privacy standards” and removes “excuses” from tech companies. EC executive vice-president Virukken noted the system is “built on zero-knowledge proof; this means that when users want to access an age-restricted service, they remain in full control of their data.”

The app verifies age via government-issued IDs and enables access through QR codes or automated checks, sharing only eligibility confirmation without revealing identity or date of birth.

The initiative addresses weak self-declaration systems and rising risks to minors, while enabling EU-wide adoption, independent audits, and innovation without vendor lock-in.

“Agentic SCA represents the next evolution of software composition analysis,” said Stuart Dross, CEO, FossID. “In this AI-driven world, software supply chain integrity has to be continuous, real-time, and built into how code gets created. That’s exactly what we’re enabling.”

NVIDIA's control of Slurm sparks AI ecosystem concerns

NVIDIA's acquisition of SchedMD, the company behind the open source workload manager Slurm, has sparked industry-wide scrutiny over whether the AI chip leader could gain structural influence over one of the most critical software layers in modern AI and high-performance computing.



The concern carries weight because Slurm powers roughly 60% of the world's supercomputers, making it a foundational open source scheduling layer for large language model training, GPU cluster orchestration, weather forecasting, government and national security systems, and large-scale enterprise AI workloads. Major AI companies, including Meta Platforms, Anthropic, and Mistral AI, rely on it for parts of their infrastructure.

At the heart of the debate is the risk of vendor bias through open source stewardship. Industry observers fear the software could see NVIDIA-first optimisation, faster feature rollouts for NVIDIA GPUs, and superior performance tuning on NVIDIA systems, while rivals such as Advanced Micro Devices and Intel face delayed parity. These concerns are amplified by precedent from NVIDIA's earlier Bright Computing acquisition, where some users reported stronger optimisation on NVIDIA hardware.

NVIDIA, however, maintains that Slurm will remain open source and vendor-neutral, arguing that its resources will accelerate development for a broader ecosystem of AI companies, research institutions, and government labs.

“We’re thrilled to join forces with NVIDIA, as this acquisition is the ultimate validation of Slurm’s critical role in the world’s most demanding HPC and AI environments,” said Danny Auble, CEO, SchedMD.

The move is now emerging as a long-term trust test for open source governance, where control of the scheduling plane could indirectly shape future AI chip adoption decisions.

SUSE expands Rancher's ecosystem with Liz AI agents

SUSE has expanded its open source Rancher ecosystem into MCP-powered agentic AI infrastructure, turning Liz from a built-in assistant into a multi-agent



orchestration layer for enterprise cloud-native operations.

The most significant update is support for Model Context Protocol (MCP), allowing third-party and internal enterprise tools to connect directly to Liz without custom integration work. This lets systems such as ticketing platforms, CMDBs, observability stacks, and security scanners

function as specialised agents inside Rancher Prime. The move extends Rancher's